

Activate the king safely

Endgame Technique

THE IDEA

In many endgames the king becomes a strong attacking and defending piece because fewer enemy pieces can generate a mating attack. Bring it toward the center or a critical pawn while checking every approach square for tactics.

WORKED EXAMPLE

A king on g1 may need several moves to reach d4. Starting that journey before the opponent creates a passed pawn can decide whether you can stop it. Remaining behind your pawns without a reason may waste your strongest available defender.

TRY IT BEFORE READING ON

What makes a king route safe enough to begin?

ANSWER AND REASONING

Identify enemy checks, protected entry squares, and whether your departure abandons a pawn or mating threat. The absence of queens helps, but rooks and minor pieces can still punish an exposed king.

TAKE THIS INTO YOUR NEXT GAME

Use the king actively after checking the opponent's forcing play.